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Introduction

What is LD?

- a wide variety of learning problems
- the brain is simply wired differently
- neurologically-based processing problems.
- a Life long condition of neurological origin
- it interferes with verbal and nonverbal abilities

LD or Learning Disability is defined as a condition giving rise to learning difficulties, especially when not associated with physical disability.

Learning disabilities are neurologically-based processing problems. These problems can interfere with learning basic skills such as reading, writing, spelling and math. They can also interfere with higher level skills such as organization, time planning, abstract reasoning, long or short term memory and attention. It is important to realize that learning disabilities can affect an individual's life beyond academics and can impact relationships with family, friends and in the workplace - <http://ldaamerica.org/types-of-learning-disabilities/>

Children and adults with Learning Disabilities are as smart if not smarter than their peers, they just have difficulties in reading, writing, spelling, reasoning, recalling and organizing.

What is NOT LD

Learning disabilities should not be confused with learning problems which are primarily the result of visual, hearing, or motor handicaps; of mental retardation; of emotional disturbance; or of environmental, cultural or economic disadvantages.

It is not mental retardation, nor visual or auditory impairment nor sub normality.

What is Cognition

Cognition is defined as the mental action or process of acquiring knowledge and understanding through thought, experience, and the senses.

Changes to the way we think, feel and perceive can make the learner an independent learner.

To know more, please visit the website ldonline.org

Importance of Remedial Education

Also known as basic skills education, this addresses the core skills of reading, spelling, writing and math. It uses techniques like a) multi-sensory approach, b) making the child see the connection with the environment, c) using their interests / potential to draw them into learning activities and d) metacognitive activities

Purpose of this Book

There are many many books on the subject of Learning Difficulties targeting professionals and parents at different levels. We are trying to bring out a practical insightful handbook that any parent/individual can use to self-learn how to deal with / do remedial intervention for their child / ward. Also, to have a list of references that describe the new ways and how to get deeper information for teaching.

We are covering the various aspects and academic and non-academic tools and techniques that can help parents / teachers / professionals learn to do Remedial Intervention by themselves. What we see in such students is a discrepancy between their potential and achievement. This book tries to help its reader becoming facilitators and serve as a scaffolding for the children to grow to their full potential.

Attitude

‘NEVER LOWER YOUR EXPECTATIONS TO THE
CHILD’S CURRENT LEVEL OF FUNCTIONING’

The important thing is not so much that every child should be taught, as that every child should be given the wish to learn. ~John Lubbock

It cannot be stressed enough the importance of right attitude!

Receiving a message that your child has learning difficulties can produce overwhelming emotions of shock, disbelief, anxiety, fear, despair and hopelessness.

Sometimes, when we lack the right attitude, we add to their difficulties. This happens when we
are not sensitive to the child’s individuality
have a high level of expectation
are not consistent in managing his behavior
force him/her to learn a nonfunctional skill

Do not think these negative thoughts or be dazed by not knowing how to cope. Think positively, act in a spirit of kindness and understanding, setting small goals and equipping yourself to handle the day to day as well as the long term challenges.

Search Idonline - <https://www.google.com/?q=parents+attitude site:ldonline.org>

Dealing with the Fact - <http://www.ldonline.org/article/5937/>

Umbrella Terms

Dyslexia, also known as reading disorder, is a learning disability characterized by trouble with reading despite normal intelligence.

Dyspraxia is a developmental disorder of the brain in childhood causing difficulty in activities requiring coordination and movement.

Dyscalculia is severe difficulty in making arithmetical calculations, as a result of brain disorder.

Dysgraphia is a type of learning disability that affects the ability to write.

ADHD / Attention Deficit Hyperactive Disorder is a chronic condition marked by persistent inattention, hyperactivity, and sometimes impulsivity

ADD / Attention Deficit Disorder is a type of ADHD where the children may be inattentive, but not hyperactive or impulsive.

Symptoms for LD

Not everyone exhibiting these symptoms have learning difficulties...

Inconsistent in work

Poor study patterns

Lack of study skills

Poor attention span

Disorganized

Hyperactive , impulsive, distractive

Day dreamer

Wanting to be perfect

Pre School

1. Mixes sounds
2. Delayed speech
3. Severe reactions with others
4. Difficulty with left and right
5. Chronic ear infections
6. Problem memorizing dates

7. Problem tying shoelaces / buttoning shirts
8. Unable to understand concepts especially math
9. Over / under dominated hands

Early schooling

1. Difficulty Writing Letters
2. Unusual pencil grip
3. Fidgeting / scribbling / looking around instead of working

Middle School

1. Memory problem
2. Not knowing what to do in spite of repeated instructions
3. Cannot maintain attention

High School

1. Problem with organization / planning
2. Time management issues
- 3.

Adults'

1. Difficulty driving
2. Reading difficulties
3. Spatial difficulties
4. Organization difficulties

Further difficulties (slide 14)

Study skills

Time Management

Retention

Organizing

Planning Behavior

Comparative Behavior

Social skills

Body language clues not noted

Facial expressions not read

Difficulty in following group rules

Verbal nuances

More symptoms can be seen here: <http://www.additudemag.com/adhd/article/3270.html> and <https://www.nichd.nih.gov/health/topics/learning/conditioninfo/pages/symptoms.aspx>

Importance of Assessments

Assessing is the process of determining the current level of your child's abilities, the effectiveness of a method or measuring the amount of progress made in his/her overall development, your understanding of the challenges and the techniques used.

There can be the child's self-assessment, a parent assessment, an academic (school / college) assessment as well as a parental self-assessment.

How do we understand their difficulties:

- How he/she performs in a test
- How he/she remembers new information
- How he/she organizes his/her work.

What we look for. Are they:

- Thinking clearly
- Spelling accurately
- Learning to compute
- Remembering facts
- Putting things in sequence
- Writing legibly
- Able to read
- Able to Copy forms
- Following directions

Other Difficulties

- Dependent on adult for directions
- Attention and concentration is low
- Easily upset under pressure
- Does not express his ideas
- Messy work
- Impulsive with what he/she does
- Low self confidence
- Feels he/she cannot do what is expected- Tells 'I can't'
- Nervous, anxious and withdrawn

Academics

Techniques to guide children and improve academic skills.

Reading

Reading is one of the fundamental methods in acquiring knowledge. Whether it is reading a story book, a newspaper or their study material decoding them is important for understanding it. When children find it difficult to read words and sentences with their present learning environment they need to learn to read

Vocabulary

Comprehension

Spelling

Writing

Math

Reasoning Activities

Study Skills

Strategies

Thinking Skills program

Non Academic

Yoga

Yoga is the Sanskrit word for ‘**union**’, and its aim is a balanced harmony of the physical needs, emotions and desires. We usually think of either asana (posture) or pranayama (meditation).

Read more: <http://savitri.in/blogs/light-of-supreme/posts/patanjali-and-sri-aurobindo>

For questions, you can write to us at

<http://yieldmore.org/ask/forums/yoga-and-meditation/> or childincorp@gmail.com

Asanas

Some common **asanas (postures)** that can be used by school children are: Surya Namaskar, Pawan Muktasana, Tadasana, Halasana, Bhugangasana, Sarvangasana.

Parents are advised to consult a doctor and do a health checkup before starting their children on any asanas / meditation and to monitor the child for symptoms like dizziness, headache etc.

Please note that minimum age for doing asanas for children is 7 years.

More information on these asanas can be had at <http://yieldmore.org/practices/yoga>

Meditation

//TODO: Add introduction.

There are plenty of guided meditation programs available at <http://brainsync.com/> including some free ones. onlinemeditation.org also has a free program.

Please note that minimum age for doing meditation for children is 12 years.

Mudras

//TODO: Add introduction.

Mudras can be used for healing certain ailments, but regular practise of mudras will contribute to overall good health and can be used as a preventive measure.

It is an ancient system that deals with the flow of life force (prana) which, like the nerves, connects the various parts of the body.

See <http://www.suprapowers.com/mudra.htm> for more information

Karate / Tai Chi

Karate and Tai Chi are martial arts aimed at developing the body, the instincts and the mind.

There are many benefits, some of them are:

more active,

focus and stillness,

learn to take hits and get up,

better self esteem and self respect,

connection between mind and body,

learn conflict resolution,

learn to breathe properly. proper oxygenation is vital and the number of people who dont do it right is staggering.

<http://breakingmuscle.com/family-kids/7-reasons-why-your-child-should-practice-martial-arts>

Swimming (Hydrotherapy)

Swimming, like walking is one of the best forms of exercise. Its benefits are health, fitness, strength and coordination, not being afraid of water, confidence and motivation.

Hydrotherapy is using the water to do simple movement and exercises. For physically disabled children, this can help reduce pain and muscle spasm, strengthen weak muscle groups, improve co-ordination, improve posture, improve balance. It is especially helpful for dyspraxic children (with low motor coordination).

<http://www.pannone.com/media-centre/articles/medical-negligence-cerebral-palsy-articles/benefits-hydrotherapy-for-children>

Dance / Movement Therapy (DMT)

DMT is defined as the psychotherapeutic use of movement to further the emotional, cognitive, physical, social, and spiritual integration of the individual.

DMT has been effective in stimulating social interaction, enhancing mood, reducing anxiety, and increasing self-awareness and self-expression.

Movement Interventions can help set limits whereby children can learn to control impulsive behavior and to increase their ability to maintain focus and attention.

<http://nspt4kids.com/parenting/therapy-moves-dancemovement-therapy-children/>

Neuro Linguistic Programming (NLP)

NLP is the science of modifying thinking (brain / neuro) / behaviour by repeating ideas or words (linguistic). Some of its uses are: Helps Change Beliefs, Helping to Reduce Anxiety.

Children with learning difficulties suffer from a lot of negative impressions about themselves and their capabilities and NLP is just the tool to lessen / remove them.

<http://www.theorganicview.com/health/what-can-nlp-and-energetic-nlp-offer-families-with-autism-and-other-learning-difficulties/>

<http://www.nlppowertraining.com.au/using-nlp-to-cure-children-with-learning-disabilities/>

Reiki / Pranic Healing

Speech and Language

Language Development

Speech Therapy

Occupational Therapy

Like physiotherapy is for the body, occupational therapy is for the mind.

Career

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Onita Nakra